Clip Desk

An n8n automation that finds a YouTube video, has an AI clipper cut it, and emails the clips. Scoping deliverable for the no-code class.

1 The need

My collaborators and I want short vertical clips from long YouTube videos, and today we find each video by hand and cut it manually in an editor; this automation does both steps from one web form and emails us the clips.

Who has the problem: anyone producing short clips for TikTok, Reels or Shorts, here me and the people I work with.
What they do today instead: search YouTube manually, upload the video to an editor, pick moments, crop and caption each clip by hand.
What success looks like: a collaborator fills in the Clip Desk page, and clips arrive by email. If no clips can be made, nothing is sent.

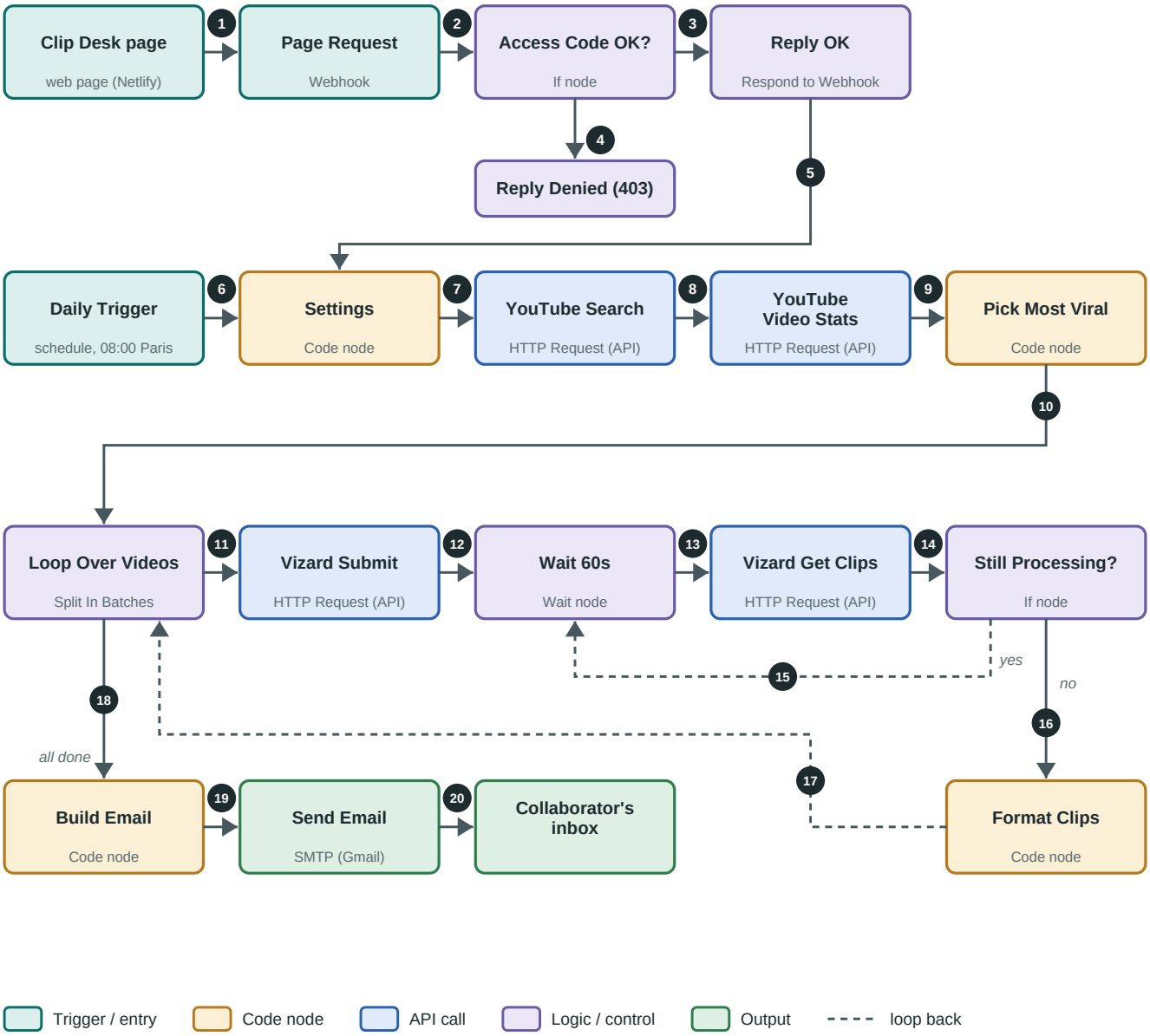
2 The trigger

Two triggers start the same pipeline. Both feed one Settings node, so everything after it behaves the same.

Trigger	What starts it	How I fire it on demand to test
Clip Desk page Webhook node	A collaborator submits the public Clip Desk web page. The page sends the filters (15 fields) to an n8n Webhook. An If node checks the shared access code first.	Open the Clip Desk page and submit it (workflow published). In the n8n editor, the Clip Request Form node's test URL does the same without the page.
Daily Trigger Schedule node	Every day at 08:00 (Europe/Paris), using the default filters written in the Settings node.	Run the workflow from the editor with Execute workflow. No waiting for 08:00.

3 The architecture diagram

Blocks are n8n nodes, arrows are the connections between them, and each numbered arrow is described on the next page.



Numbered circles match the arrows in the table on the next page. The 'Clip Request Form' node (the original n8n form) is not drawn; it feeds the same Settings node and is kept as a backup front end.

What travels on each arrow

#	Arrow	What travels on it
1	Clip Desk page to Page Request	JSON with the 15 form fields: email, access code, language, region, keyword, category, published within, sort by, minimum views, max video length, number of videos, clips per video, clip length, aspect ratio, clip topic.
2	Page Request to Access Code OK?	The same fields (inside a body object).
3	Access Code OK? to Reply OK	Nothing new. Taken when the access code matches.
4	Access Code OK? to Reply Denied	Taken when the code is wrong. The page gets HTTP 403 and shows an error; the run ends.
5	Reply OK to Settings	The form fields. The page also receives a confirmation that the request was accepted.
6	Daily Trigger to Settings	Only a timestamp. Settings fills in everything from its defaults.
7	Settings to YouTube Search	One clean object: YouTube search parameters (language, region, keyword, category, date window, sort order), Vizard options, recipient email, number of videos, maximum video minutes, minimum views.
8	YouTube Search to YouTube Video Stats	Up to 50 search results: video IDs, titles and channels. Search results carry no view counts.
9	YouTube Video Stats to Pick Most Viral	Full details for those videos: view count, duration, category, audio language, live status.
10	Pick Most Viral to Loop Over Videos	1 to 3 videos that passed every filter: id, title, channel, views, length, URL. If none pass, the run stops with a clear error.
11	Loop Over Videos to Vizard Submit	One video at a time: its URL and title.
12	Vizard Submit to Wait 60s	projectId, Vizard's ticket number for the clipping job.
13	Wait 60s to Vizard Get Clips	Nothing new. A 60 second pause.
14	Vizard Get Clips to Still Processing?	A status code and the list of clips so far (empty while Vizard is working).
15	Still Processing? to Wait 60s (yes)	Taken while Vizard is still working, up to 60 checks, then the workflow gives up on that video.
16	Still Processing? to Format Clips (no)	Vizard's final answer: the clips, or an empty list.
17	Format Clips to Loop Over Videos	The video plus a status and its clips (title, download link, edit link, viral score, seconds). The loop then starts the next video.
18	Loop Over Videos to Build Email (done)	All videos with their clips, once the last video has finished.
19	Build Email to Send Email	Recipient, subject and HTML body. If there are zero clips in total it returns nothing, so no email is sent.
20	Send Email to the inbox	The email: download links (valid 7 days), edit links and a viral score for each clip.

Design choices

Links, not files. Vizard receives the YouTube URL and downloads the video itself. Nothing is downloaded in n8n.

Search, not the trending chart. YouTube retired its Trending page in 2025, so videos come from a filtered search sorted by views.

Polling. Clipping takes minutes, so the workflow asks Vizard every 60 seconds, up to 60 times, then gives up on that video.

A person reviews the clips. They are emailed, not posted automatically.

Cost guards. An access code, a cap on source video length and at most 3 videos per request protect the monthly Vizard allowance of about 600 minutes.

4 The level I am aiming at

Target: a complete, working automation that people other than its author use: two triggers, two external APIs, input checks, a polling loop with a retry limit, and a public web front end that non-technical collaborators can operate.

If I run out of time, I cut in this order:

1. The public Clip Desk page. The built-in n8n form does the same job as a front end.
2. The extra filters (category, sort order, minimum views, clip topic). The core needs only language, region, keyword and length.
3. Multi-video requests. One video per run still delivers the whole idea.

I never cut the core: YouTube search, Vizard clipping and the email.

5 Minimum technical requirements

The brief asks for at least one of each item below. This is where each one appears in the project today.

Requirement	Where it is in the project
If or Set node	**Access Code OK?** checks the access code. **Still Processing?** decides whether to keep waiting for Vizard.
Code node	Four Code nodes: **Settings** (merges triggers, builds the API requests), **Pick Most Viral** (filters and ranks videos), **Format Clips**, **Build Email**.
Router or If/Switch statement	Access Code OK? routes right code to Reply OK and wrong code to Reply Denied. Still Processing? routes to another wait or to Format Clips. Loop Over Videos routes to each video or to done.
API or MCP connection	YouTube Data API (search and video stats) and Vizard API (create a clipping project, fetch its clips), through HTTP Request nodes with saved credentials.
Message trigger (Telegram, WhatsApp, Discord, Slack; not Chat Message)	Current triggers are a web page webhook, an n8n form and a schedule. None is a messaging trigger.
Database for data persistence	Requests and results are not stored anywhere. The only record is n8n's execution history.
AI node (LLM Chain or AI Agent)	The AI clipping is done by Vizard through its API. The workflow has no n8n AI node.
Sub-workflow	The whole pipeline is one workflow.
Error handling and retries	Done: the polling loop retries every 60 seconds up to 60 times, Pick Most Viral stops with a clear error if nothing matches, a wrong access code gets a 403, and a video with no clips sends no email. Missing: an error workflow that alerts me when a run fails, and retry-on-fail on the API nodes.